EXPO STARS

THE 2023 AUTO EXPO MIGHT HAVE BECOME A BIT SMALLER THAN USUAL, BUT THERE WAS NO SHORTAGE OF SHOWSTOPPERS OR CARS THAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO LAY YOUR HANDS ON SOON



The 16th edition of the Auto Expo that was supposed to be held last year was finally held earlier this month and saw a record number of visitors at its current venue in Greater Noida. This despite a number of car manufacturers giving it a miss due to high costs of participation, a throttled product pipeline, ongoing supply constraints, bulging order books on account of the pandemic and global chip shortages. Nearly 600,000 visitors saw an industry that is in transition—a majority of the new vehicles displayed have drivetrains that rely on substances other than petrol and diesel to power them. While battery electric vehicles were there in virtually every stall, there were also flex-fuel vehicles, hydrogen-powered vehicles, fuel cell vehicles and, of course, the hybrids.

While over 90 per cent of the passenger car industry was pres-



MARUTI SUZUKI FRONX

Based on the Heartect platform that also underpins the Baleno, the Fronx comes with a crossover design. LED headlamps sit on the new bumper and then there are sleek LED DRLs on top. Scuff plates can be seen both upfront and rear. There are plenty of black plastic claddings all around too. Inside, the Fronx gets a new dual-tone finish and premium features. The 1.2-litre K-series petrol engine is in the offing. The game-changer comes in form of the 1.0-litre Turbo Booster Jet engine which is tuned to 100bhp and 147.6Nm of torque. The Fronx will also be offered with a 6-speed automatic along with paddle shifters.